

Official rules – El Mundial

A new beginning, a new legacy... Created by nine-time world champions Karen and Ricardo, El Mundial is the culmination of their passion and excellence in Latin dance. With over 20 years of experience, they have revolutionized the scene, taking dance to an unprecedented professional level. This championship seeks the best dancers in the world, blending technique, passion, and Latin essence. More than a competition, El Mundial is a platform to transform careers, open doors, and elevate dance to the highest level. El Mundial, where dreams become history.

KAREN & RICARDO

I-General

1.1. The competition aims to promote excellence in Latin dance, recognizing technique, athleticism, creativity, musicality, and artistic expression.

1.2. Dancers of any nationality may participate, but only those who have been selected in their country's national final will compete in El Mundial's final. Additionally, each allied Mundial will feature a special guest.

1.3. The organizers reserve the right to modify these rules if necessary, ensuring fairness and transparency for all participants.

2. Category, Level, and Dance Styles

2.1. Age Categories

- Junior (7-11 years old)
- Youth (12-17 years old)
- Adult (18-50 years old)

2.2. Categories by Dance Level

- Amateur: A dancer who does not receive a primary income from participating in competitions, exhibitions, or teaching dance. They generally compete in non-professional categories and undergo a training and development process within the dance or social dance circuit. Although they may have a high technical level, they are not considered an elite or professional dancer according to the regulations of many federations and competitions.
- Professional: A dancer who receives income from their dance activity, whether through competitions, exhibitions, teaching, or artistic contracts. They are distinguished by their high technical level, experience, and recognition in the dance field. Furthermore, they will be considered professional even if they do not specifically dance this style, if they are already professional in another dance discipline.
- ProAm: The ProAm category consists of a couple or group where professional dancers perform alongside amateurs. It can be presented as couples, duos, or choreographic groups. This category was created to foster the development of non-professional dancers, giving them the opportunity to share the stage with more experienced performers.

2.3. Categories and Styles

Salsa Categories Amateur-Professional-ProAm

- 1. Female Solo
- 2. Male Solo
- 3. Female Shine Duo
- 4. Male Shine Duo
- 5. Classic Salsa Couples
- 6. Salsa Cabaret Couples
- 7. Same Gender Male
- 8. Same Gender Female
- 9. Classic Salsa Groups
- 10. Salsa Cabaret Group
- 11. Male Shine Team
- 12. Female Shine Team
- 13. Mixed Shine Team

Chachachá Categories Amateur-Professional-ProAm

- 1. Female Solo
- 2. Male Solo
- 3. Female Shine Duo
- 4. Male Shine Duo
- 5. Cha-cha-chá Couples
- 6. Cha-cha-chá Groups
- 7. Male Shine Team
- 8. Female Shine Team
- 9. Mixed Shine Team

Bachata Categories Amateur-Professional-ProAm

- 1. Female Solo
- 2. Male Solo
- 3. Female Shine Duo
- 4. Male Shine Duo
- 5. Classic Bachata Couples
- 6. Bachata Cabaret Couples
- 7. Classic Bachata Groups
- 8. Bachata Cabaret Group
- 9. Male Shine Team
- 10. Female Shine Team
- 11. Mixed Shine Team

Merengue Categories Amateur-Professional-ProAm

- 1. Female Solo
- 2. Male Solo
- 3. Female Shine Duo
- 4. Male Shine Duo
- 5. Merengue Couples
- 6. Merengue Groups
- 7. Male Shine Team
- 8. Female Shine Team
- 9. Mixed Shine Team

3. Competition Format

3.1. Competition Stages



3.2. Presentation Time

1	Solo 1:30 – 1:50 minutes.	2	Couples 1:45 – 2:00 minutes.	3	Groups/Duo Shine/Team Shines 2:00 – 2:30 minutes.
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3.3. Competition Modification

• The organizers reserve the right to modify the order of the rounds, the ranking methods, and the competition format if necessary, always for the benefit of the competitors and ensuring fairness, transparency, and appreciation of each participant's effort. Any changes will be made with the commitment to maintaining the impartiality and competitive spirit of the event.

4-Music and its Elements in Choreography

4.1. Music in Choreography

- Each participant must submit their own high-quality music, sending it to the organizers or uploading it to the web platform as stipulated in the regulations. It is recommended to stay tuned for official updates.
- The music must correspond to the style of the category in which they are competing.
- No more than three songs of the same style may be combined within the choreography.
- If the music includes combinations with other rhythms, such as hip hop, cha-cha-cha, or samba, these may not exceed 10 seconds in total.
- The duration of the music must comply with the time specified in the regulations for each category.
- Failure to comply with these rules will result in a 1-point penalty, which could affect qualification for the next round.

4.2. Use of Additional Elements

- The use of elements external to the costumes, such as scenery, performance props, confetti, flags, or any additional objects, is prohibited.
- The use of hats, flags, or items alluding to any country, religion, or brand is prohibited, including costumes with visible commercial logos.
- Nothing may be detached, placed, or falling from the costumes during the performance.
- Failure to comply with these rules will result in a 1-point penalty.

Music Penalties

- Use of inappropriate music (containing offensive content, vulgar language, or not respecting the essence of the dance) → Immediate disqualification.
- Exceeding the allowed music time → -1 point, without prior warning.
- Errors in music submission (incorrect format or audio failure caused by the competitor) → -1 point, without prior warning, and possible disqualification if not resolved before the performance.

5. Dress Code, Makeup, and Hairstyling

5.1. Permitted Attire

- Costumes must be specifically designed for the competition, professionally crafted, and in harmony with the dance style and music selected. Street clothes are not permitted in any category.
- They must highlight the competitor's skills and be of a high-performance athletic level, with a design appropriate to the category.
- Sequins, glitter, and eye-catching visual elements are permitted, provided they do not pose a safety risk.
- Creativity and originality in the design are essential, ensuring that the costume is an extension of the dancer's artistic expression.
- Costumes must be properly secured to prevent them from becoming detached during the performance. Any item that falls off the costume, such as excessive glitter, headpieces, or other accessories, will be penalized with a one-point deduction.

5.2. Costume Obligations and Restrictions

Women (Adults):

- The use of fishnet stockings and shoes with a minimum heel of 7 cm is mandatory.
- The use of string bikinis or string bottoms as competition attire is prohibited.
- The attire must cover at least 50% of the buttocks, with no possibility of tucking the garment into the rear end.
- Excessive slits in the front of the attire or exaggerated neckline openings are prohibited.
- Attire must reflect elegance and sophistication, and must be sexy without losing good taste or the aesthetics appropriate for an international competition.

Men (Adults):

- Excessively tight pants, such as leggings or skinny jeans, are prohibited. Appropriate dance pants must be worn.
- Dance shoes with a minimum 2cm heel are mandatory.
- Long socks are mandatory, ensuring no skin is exposed.
- Chests must not be exposed, and shirts must be long or short-sleeved, avoiding exaggerated openings in the chest.
- Sleeveless shirts or tank tops are prohibited.

5.3. Costume Obligations and Restrictions

Boys and Juniors:

- Female attire: Fishnet stockings and shoes with a minimum 2 cm heel are mandatory. They must wear full dresses; two-piece outfits are not permitted. The design must cover at least 80% of the buttocks, ensuring the rear is adequately covered.
- Male attire: No upper body exposure or clothing that leaves arms uncovered. Dance pants, long-sleeved shirts, and appropriate dance shoes are required.

General (For all categories and ages):

Costume designs must be appropriate for each competitor's age, avoiding any design that exposes the body of minors. They must reflect elegance, professionalism, and respect for the discipline, as this competition seeks to produce champions who can represent dance in any country and for any culture or religion. The image of the dancers and their category will be respected, maintaining a quality standard appropriate for a world championship.

Costume designs will not be considered an element of skill nor may they be used to gain an advantage in the evaluation. Their use as a choreographic resource (for example, removing, adding, or manipulating clothing as part of the performance) will not be permitted. Scoring will be based exclusively on the creativity, technical execution, artistic expression, and dance quality of each competitor.

5.4. Makeup:

- Makeup is optional, but must be in harmony with the dance, choreography, and chosen theme.
- Men and women: Makeup is mandatory and must enhance the skin, ensuring it looks fresh and glowing on stage, without overdoing it with a tan or excessive product. Its purpose is to highlight the dancer's expression and presence during the competition without distracting or overwhelming the dancer's image.
- Minors: Excessive or age-inappropriate makeup must be avoided, maintaining an appearance appropriate to their category.

5.5. Hairstyle:

- Hairstyles must be neat, professional, and appropriate for a dance competition, not a street hairstyle.
- It is mandatory for both men and women and must allow the face to be fully visible.
- It must be neat and firm, without interfering with the dance performance or affecting the dancer's facial expression.
- If a woman wears a headdress or extensions, they must be securely fastened and cannot fall off during the performance. If they become detached, a penalty of 1 point will be applied.

Costume-Related Penalties

- Inappropriate attire (overly revealing or not in line with the competition's dress code) → -1 point or disqualification.
- Costume malfunctions that affect the performance (e.g., falling embellishments, excessive glitter, loose garments causing distraction) → -1 point.
- Use of commercial logos or unauthorized advertising → Warning and possible disqualification if not corrected.

6. Definitions and Technical Specifications

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6.1. Turns and Spins

- Turns: Controlled dancer movement that is not considered acrobatics, lift, or trick.
- Continuous turns in partnering: a maximum of 4 bars/16 beats/2 counts of 8 are allowed for continuous turns. Exceeding this will result in a 1 point penalty in the final score.
- Static turns: e.g., turns in place. For all divisions, static turns must have a maximum of 8 bars/32 pulses/4 counts of 8. Exceeding the maximum will result in a -1 point in the final result.

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6.2. Tricks, Lifts, Dips, and Assists

- We define: A **trick** as any advanced movement that requires coordination, strength, or flexibility beyond basic steps (can be aerial or not). A **lift** is an elevation in which a dancer lifts their partner off the ground above the waist. A **dip** and **assist** is a controlled movement with leader support, without losing contact with the ground or at least one foot must remain on the ground. A dip/assist is any help to facilitate a movement, such as providing momentum, balance, or stability. These elements must be executed fluidly so that they are not counted as more than one.

Regulations for Specific Categories:

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Classic Categories:

Up to three tricks, dips, or assists are allowed per routine, regardless of whether they are performed by the leader or the follower. In each execution, at least one foot must remain in contact with the floor and a second impulse cannot be generated to repeat the movement. Additionally, each trick must not occupy more than three counts of eight in the choreography. It is important to remember that in this category, 80% of the dance must be continuous, reflecting the corresponding style with an emphasis on footwork and partnering.

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Cabaret Categories:

Unlimited use of tricks, dips, and assists is allowed, but maintaining the essence of Latin dance. This category seeks to combine showmanship with musicality, so acrobatic elements must not exceed 50% of the choreography. This includes tricks, lifts, and any fusion elements with Latin dance, ensuring a balance between technique and musical interpretation.



Regulation for Team Shine (Female, Male, or Mixed)

Team Shine, whether female, male, or mixed, are composed of solo dancers who execute a synchronized footwork choreography without partner turns.

A maximum of three lifts, dips, or tricks are allowed per routine. They can perform acrobatics without physical contact, but at least 80% of the choreography must be continuous dancing, highlighting the footwork and musicality. No partnering is allowed between the members (dancing).

Note: The focus of this category is to highlight the precision, coordination, and creativity within the chosen dance style, while maintaining the essence of Team Shine.



Regulation for Same Gender

The Same Gender category is composed of a pair of two dancers of the same sex who execute a choreography combining partnering and footwork. Unlimited use of lifts, dips, tricks, and assists is allowed. At least 60% of the choreography must be continuous dancing, maintaining the essence of the chosen dance style. The choreography must integrate a balance between footwork and partnering, ensuring fluidity and musicality.

Note: The objective of this category is to highlight the creativity, connection, and technique of the pair within the dance style, respecting the structure of the competition.



Regulation for Duo Shines

The Duo Shines category is composed of two solo dancers who execute a choreography focused exclusively on footwork (shines), without performing partner figures and turns. A maximum of three dips, tricks, or lifts are allowed per routine. They can perform acrobatics without physical contact, but at least 80% of the choreography must be continuous dancing with an emphasis on footwork and musicality.

No partnering is allowed, which means they cannot execute turns, partner combinations, or characteristic figures of styles such as salsa or other rhythms danced in pairs.

Note: The focus of this category is to highlight the precision, creativity, and synchronization in the footwork, while maintaining the essence of the chosen dance style.



Regulations for ProAm

In the ProAm categories, although this competition will evaluate the teamwork (pair or group), the director or choreographer is recommended to design the routine according to the amateur student's level, with the aim of enhancing their performance and achieving a solid execution that allows for a good evaluation.

In the case of ProAm groups, the composition must have a minimum of 60% amateur dancers and a maximum of 40% professionals.

Penalties Related to Tricks, Dips, and Lifts

- Exceeding the number of allowed tricks, dips, or lifts in a category → -1 point for each additional element.
- Performing a full lift in a category that does not allow it → Disqualification in that round.
- Use of dangerous tricks without control or falls due to lack of technique → Warning on the first instance and possible disqualification if it jeopardizes the safety of the dancer or their partner.

Evaluation Criteria

1	Timing 20% The designated salsa music timing for this competition is 1-2-3, 5-6-7. Participants can choose to "break" on 1 or 2, but must maintain consistency throughout the routine. The direction of the first step can be forward or backward, as long as the timing (either 1 and 5 or 2 and 6) is maintained consistently. The majority of the routine should clearly demonstrate the designated salsa music timing.
2	Musicality 10% They will demonstrate their ability to creatively work with the music. This can be done in various ways, including patterns, steps, accents, tricks, etc. The jury will evaluate the level of interpretation of the chosen music. How effectively did the couples use the phrasing and accents of their chosen music? Were they rhythmically synchronized with the piece?
3	Latin Dance Technique 15% This refers to the correct execution of the characteristic movements of rhythms such as salsa, bachata, mambo, cha-cha-cha, afro, and rumba. It includes the proper use of the hips, feet, body isolation, and posture, maintaining the authenticity and essence of each dance. The couple connection, precision in turns, and synchronization with the music should appear natural and effortless. The technique should reflect control, fluidity, and elegance in each movement, avoiding misalignments, imbalances, and timing errors. It is essential that, despite the high competitive performance, the essence of Latin dance remains intact.
4	External Dance Technique 5% This corresponds to the correct application of technical elements from disciplines such as jazz, ballet, contemporary, hip hop, and other fused rhythms in the choreographies. Extensions, lines, turns, pirouettes, and tricks that are not rooted in Latin dance will be evaluated. The execution must demonstrate precise control of the movement, with correct alignments, balance, and projection. Good technique implies that each step, turn, or trick is performed with control and mastery, ensuring that the fusion appears fluid and coherent within the choreography.
5	Difficulty 10% What was the level of the turns, patterns, movement entanglements, polished movements, trick level, etc. The number of double and single turns, movements that require exceptional balance, flexibility, or effort. Were all attempted movements executed successfully? Example: In the Cabaret Division, what was the difficulty in the lift work? In on2, what was the difficulty of their salsa? Was it properly executed? And the jumps, kicks, extensions? To achieve a good score, any of these movements must be executed successfully.
6	Connection and Synchronization 10% This reflects the aspect of couple leading and whether they are truly connected with the salsa technique or are just executing a choreography. In groups, the synchronization and coordination throughout the dance will help determine the score in this category. Poorly executed connections will deduct points, which will be determined by the jury.
7	Choreography 10% This refers to the set of steps, the composition, and the structure of how the movements are integrated into the music. A good choreography should stand out for the efficient use of space, the essence of the interpreted rhythm, the diversity in movement patterns, dynamic changes, and clean transitions. It should show a sequence of subtle and interesting impacts to maintain a good choreographic composition and ensure a fluid and attractive execution.
8	Originality 10% This refers to the ability to innovate by creating new elements, unique combinations of steps, turns, tricks, free footwork, novel salsa combinations, new transitions, and position changes. Originality implies bringing fresh concepts, unexpected transitions, and distinctive details that differentiate the routine from others. It is not enough to have a good choreography; originality adds value when novel elements are incorporated that enrich the execution without losing the essence of the dance.
9	Stage Presence 5% This refers to the attitude, confidence, and professionalism projected by the team or couple on stage. It implies demonstrating confidence, connection, and charisma during the execution, capturing the audience's attention. Stage presence is reflected in the facial expression, posture, energy, and the way the movements are controlled, maintaining interest throughout the routine.
10	Visual Presence 5% This refers to the overall image and visual impact of the team or couple on stage, highlighting the costume, hairstyle, and makeup. These elements should be coherent, aesthetically pleasing, original, coordinated, and in harmony with the dance style, without distracting or clashing. Additionally, the costume should remain in place throughout the presentation and respect the established rules. Visual presence also implies that the appearance reflects professionalism and elegance, reinforcing the identity and message of the choreography.

8- Rules of Conduct and Professionalism

1 Sportsmanship

- Absolute respect is expected between competitors, judges, and the audience at all times, both on stage and backstage.
- The use of vocabulary must be impeccable, avoiding offensive or derogatory comments or any attitude that generates conflicts.
- Unsportsmanlike conduct, disrespect, or inappropriate behavior may result in sanctions or disqualification.
- It is strictly forbidden to make gestures of displeasure, verbal or physical aggression towards judges, organizers, the public, or other competitors. Any behavior of this nature will be sanctioned with possible immediate disqualification.
- It is prohibited to lie about the registration of categories, attempting to compete in a division that does not correspond to the established level or requirements.
- Competitors must be responsible with schedules and attend mandatory meetings, respecting the established planning.

3 Compliance with Rules and Official Decisions

- All competitors, including participants and attendees, must fully respect the competition regulations and any modifications.
- The decisions of the panel of judges are final, and any attempt to question them or alter the results may result in sanctions.
- Judges are not obligated to provide feedback to competitors. This is entirely at their discretion and will depend on their availability once the competition is over.
- Failure to comply with the established rules may result in disqualification or even the revocation of titles and prizes earned.

2 Mindset and Attitude

- From the beginning of the competition, a healthy competitive mindset is expected, with a positive and open disposition to improvement.
- Accept the result with sportsmanship and learn from the experience.
- Maintain a positive attitude and focus on improving your performance.
- All participants can provide constructive feedback when required, fostering an environment of growth and professionalism.
- The competition may involve changes in the schedule during the event year, so it is the competitor's responsibility to be attentive to any official updates.

4 Spirit and Respect in and for EL MUNDIAL

- EL MUNDIAL is based on the values of respect, professionalism, and excellence, and every competitor must align with this spirit.
- Those who do not comply with the spirit of the competition, the positive mindset, and respect for others may be sanctioned and even lose their right to compete in future editions.
- Professionalism both on and off the stage is a fundamental part of this competition. All participants are expected to maintain a responsible, ethical, and aligned conduct with the event's vision of excellence.

General and Conduct Penalties

- Unsportsmanlike conduct (disrespect, verbal or physical aggression towards judges, organizers, the public, or other competitors) → Immediate disqualification and possible ban from future competitions.
- Disrespect towards judges or expressions of displeasure on stage or backstage → Warning and possible disqualification in case of recurrence.
- Not respecting the category in which they were registered (e.g., participating in a lower level than the one corresponding) → Automatic disqualification.
- Failing to attend mandatory meetings or ignoring changes in the schedule → -1 point, Warning and possible disqualification in case of recurrence.
- Attempting to alter or manipulate the results of the competition → Immediate disqualification and withdrawal of any prize won.

9. Registrations and Payment Methods

9.1. Registration Process

- For NATIONAL TEAMS, a form provided by the corresponding organization will be filled out within the established dates.
- For the EL MUNDIAL 2026, all competitors must complete the registration form through the official EL MUNDIAL web platform, within the established dates.
- It is mandatory to provide truthful and up-to-date information in the registration.
- The registration will only be valid once the corresponding payment has been completed.
- Registrations can be updated or modified until the established deadline.

9.2. Payment Methods

- Bank transfer (the details will be provided at the time of registration).
- Online payment through authorized digital platforms.
- Costs and commissions may vary depending on the country and the payment method used.

9.3. Registration Update and Competitor Responsibility

- It is the responsibility of each competitor to be aware of any updates in the registration procedures, payments, and schedule changes.
- The organizers reserve the right to modify the dates or conditions according to the needs of the event.
- In case of errors in the registration, competitors will have a determined time to report and correct them. After this period, no modifications will be allowed.
- There are no refunds for registration fees. In case of not being able to attend, the registration can be transferred to another person or postponed to the following year, as long as it is notified within the deadlines established by the organization.

This section ensures a transparent and organized registration process, making the non-refund policy clear and offering alternatives in case of changes in plans.



10-Official Awards

1 10.1- Information on Awards and Benefits

- Any updates on awards, additional benefits or opportunities for competitors will be communicated externally to the regulations, through official digital platforms and other information channels.
- The organization will always strive to offer more benefits to the dancers, so the prizes and recognitions may be expanded or adjusted according to the development of the event.

2 10.2- Official Awards

- Trophies, medals and official recognitions for the winners of each category.
- Cash prizes, trips or study scholarships; depending on the category, total registered and availability of the organization.

3 10.3- Conditions for Receiving Awards

- All prizes are personal and non-transferable. They cannot be transferred, sold or claimed by third parties.
- The collection of prizes or scholarships must be made within the dates established by the organization. After this period, the competitor will lose their right to the prize without the possibility of a claim.
- The prizes will be subject to the current regulations and norms, depending on each country or organizing entity.

This point guarantees transparency and clarity in the delivery of prizes, ensuring that the dancers are always informed through the official digital channels of El Mundial.

Loss of Prizes or Destitution of Titles

Competitors may lose their prizes or be deposed of their titles if it is detected that:

- They did not comply with the rules of their category.
- They failed to comply with the established rules of respect and professionalism.
- They manipulated information in their registration or altered the competition dishonestly.

II-Final Provisions

II.1-Image Rights and Recordings

- By registering for the competition, participants authorize the organization to record, photograph and disseminate their performances in any medium, including digital platforms, social networks, television and promotional material.
- All image rights and audiovisual material generated during the event will be the exclusive property of the organization, without additional compensation for the participants.

II.2-Responsibility of Competitors

- Each competitor is responsible for their own body and the execution of their movements, including tricks, lifts, dips and any choreographic elements.
- The organization is not responsible for injuries, accidents or health problems that may occur before, during or after the competition.
- No medical coverage or accident insurance is provided, so participants are recommended to have their own health insurance and take the necessary precautions for their safety.

II.3-Cancellation or Modification of the Event due to Force Majeure

- In case of force majeure (natural disasters, health crises, social conflicts, government restrictions, among others), the organization reserves the right to cancel, reschedule or modify the event without the obligation to reschedule it on a specific date.
- In case of rescheduling, no refunds will be made, but the organization may offer alternative solutions at its discretion.

II.4-Acceptance and Update of the Regulations

- Registration for the competition implies full acceptance of these regulations and compliance with all its rules.
- Participants are advised to review the regulations annually for any updates, as the organization may make modifications to improve the structure and quality of the event.

This point clarifies the image rights, the competitors' responsibility for their health, the possible cancellation due to force majeure, and the need to be attentive to updates to the regulations.

Thank you for being part of this competition!

On behalf of the entire EL MUNDIAL team, we thank you for your effort and passion for dance. We wish you the best on the stage. Trust your talent and enjoy every step.

See you on the dance floor!